



Data Science Vs. Cancer

Scientist may soon be able to finally understand cancer with the help of big data and machine learning. <http://dgit.in/dataCancer>



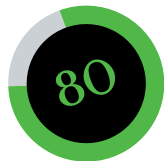
Retro-style E-moped

Chinese automobile company Munro Motor launches a new retro-style electric moped "Mumro 2.0". <http://dgit.in/RetroBike>

Bazaar

WD Blue SSD 250GB

Back in the SSD game



Performance.....79
Build75
Value for Money 84

Specifications

WDS250G1B0A

Form factor: 2.5-

inch; Cost/GB: ₹27.2;

Dimensions: 100.5 x

69.9 x 7 mm; Controller:

Marvell 88SS1074,

SanDisk 15nm TLC;

Warranty: 3 years

Contact

WD

Phone: 1800-200-5789,

Email: Website form,

Website: www.wdc.com

WD's acquisition of SanDisk has now resulted in a new lineup of SSDs aimed at the mid-range and budget segments. They follow the same Blue and Green branding for these two segments, respectively. This isn't WD's first foray into the SSD business, they'd released the SiliconEdge Blue drives about seven years ago and that was followed by the WD Black2 hybrid drive a couple of years later. And now, we have the WD Blue and WD Green SSDs with WD Black SSDs to be launched in the first half.

The WD Blue SSD makes use of the Marvell 88SS1074 controller with SanDisk's 15nm TLC NAND. This configuration isn't new as it's the same as the SanDisk X400 SSDs but with different capacities. Needless to say, this change in



Price
₹6,799

configuration will require firmware modification as well and thus the performance of the WD Blue SSD will vary from that of the SanDisk X400. Prior to conditioning the drives, we ran a few synthetic tests and the numbers came back reflecting WD's spec sheet. Sequential read

and write speeds were at 538 MBps and 520 MBps, respectively. 4KQD32 read and write speeds were at 383 MBps and 329 MBps. Post conditioning, sequential speeds dropped to roughly 270-310 MBps which is pretty decent for TLC NAND SSDs. The WD Blue SSD offers good performance given that it is using TLC NAND but is about ₹650 bucks more expensive than other TLC SSDs in the price bracket. Take that out of the picture and you've got a winner.

Mithun Mobandas

GIGABYTE AORUS GA-Z270X-Gaming 9

Supercharged enthusiast board

Kabylake motherboards have accelerated the race to bring greater diversity between motherboards in terms of features. The 200 series boards add more HSIO lanes to operate simultaneously with existing PCIe, unlocking a wider set of connectivity options. The GIGABYTE AORUS GA-Z270X-Gaming 9 being the top of the line motherboard from GIGABYTE is laden with features targeted at the enthusiast segment. Straight off the bat, we noticed the EKWB water block with G1/4-inch threading for the VRM circuitry. Every fan header on the board is rated to push 2 amperes, so you can connect your water cooling pump or high-draw air coolers to any of the headers. To aid with cooling, there are additional temperature sensors on the board and

an improved fan speed control software gives greater flexibility.

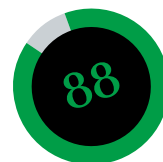
Taking RGB madness to an entirely new level, you now have RGB leds in all sorts of places – around the VRM circuitry, PCIe expansion slots, between RAM slots, and more. And if

these many options weren't enough then you do have headers to connect extra strips. On the performance aspect, RAID has been extended to both U.2 and M.2 ports. So you can club all the three ports on the board in RAID 0 for some unrealistic transfer speeds. GIGABYTE has really thrown in every single accessory you would ever need with the motherboard, and the price does seem a little high but once you factor in the cooling block, the pricing starts to make sense.

Mithun Mobandas



Price
₹61,800



Features.....90
Build85

Specifications

Chipset: Intel Z270;

Memory support:

4x4133(OC)MHz upto

64GB; LAN: 2x Killer

E2500 Gigabit; Audio:

ALC1220 7.1; SATA: 8x

SATA III; Expansion: 4x

PCIe X16(x16+x16+x8+x8);

Dimensions: 305 mm x

264 mm; Warranty:

3 years.

Contact

GIGABYTE

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